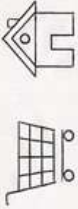




AUSTRALIA'S COST OF LIVING CRISIS

How Rising Costs Are Pressuring Households Across the Country



1 HEADER & HERO

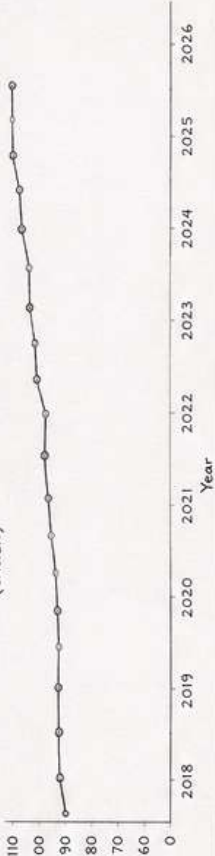
Rising living costs are reshaping financial pressure across Australian households, with housing, food and transport becoming the largest burdens.

2 NATIONAL ECONOMIC OVERVIEW

COST OF LIVING PRESSURE ACROSS AUSTRALIA (Overall Index)

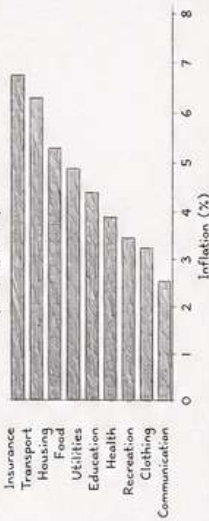


CPI TREND IN AUSTRALIA (Index)

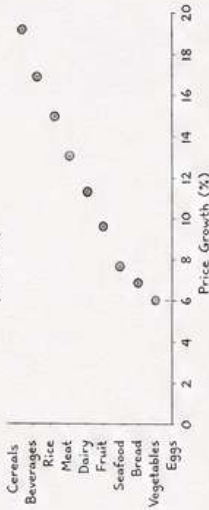


3 DAILY LIVING COST ANALYSIS

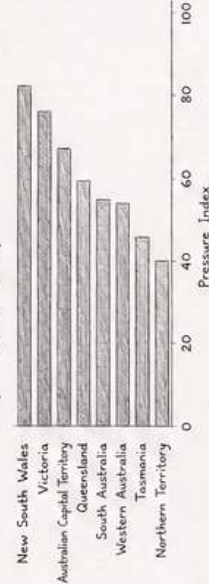
INFLATION BY SPENDING CATEGORY (Annual %)



FOOD PRICE GROWTH BY CATEGORY (YoY %)



OVERALL COST PRESSURE RANKING BY STATE (Pressure Index)



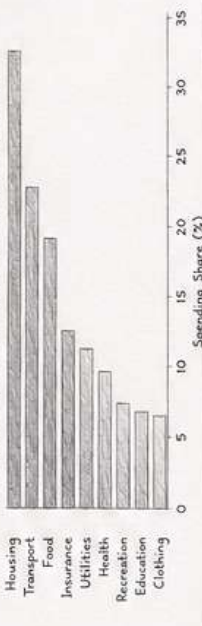
4 WHERE ARE HOUSEHOLDS FEELING THE MOST PRESSURE?

COST PRESSURE BY STATE AND SPENDING CATEGORY (Pressure Index)



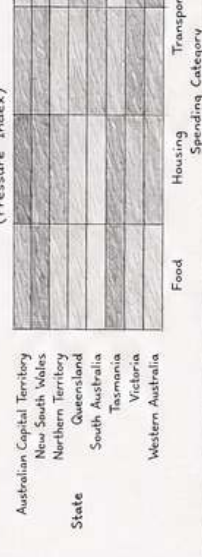
5 WHICH EXPENSES TAKE THE BIGGEST SHARE?

HOUSEHOLD SPENDING SHARE & INFLATION PRESSURE



6 ARE WAGES KEEPING UP WITH RENT?

RENT GROWTH COMPARED WITH WAGE GROWTH (Annual %)



7 KEY FINDINGS

HIGHEST PRESSURE



New South Wales records the highest pressure index.

FASTEST RISING COST



Insurance shows the strongest inflation pressure among major categories.

RENT GAP



Rent growth in New South Wales is much higher than wage growth.

8 CONCLUSION

The cost of living crisis affects all Australians, but the impact varies greatly across states and categories. Targeted actions are needed to relieve financial pressure on households.

Data Sources: Australian Bureau of Statistics (ABS), CPI datasets, household expenditure datasets and state-level cost pressure indicators.

Date: 29 May 2026

Designed by: Don Ratnayake

STORY FLOW

- 1 Introduction
- 2 National Overview
- 3 Daily Living Costs
- 4 Pressure Comparison
- 5 Household Expenses
- 6 Key Findings
- 7 Conclusion

DATA SOURCES:

- ABS (CPI, Wages, Spending)
- SQM Research (Rents)
- Fuel Price Australia
- ABS (Household Expenditure)
- State Cost Pressure Indicators

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